



MONTHLY UPDATE

Cape Verde: monthly update, August – September 2026

Edition of 2026-09-04 · 8 systems and instruments tracked

Developments summarised from sources published between the beginning of last month and today.

SUMMARY OF THE MONTH · GOVERNANCE · ICT INFRASTRUCTURE · DPI · TECHNOLOGY

Summary of the month

Statistics rather than systems carried the month. The Prime Minister told Parliament on 31 July that the national statistics institute had produced falsified data and ordered an independent evaluation of it; [the institute's board rejected the allegations three days later and offered to host any external review](#), and nothing is established about the evaluation's terms, who conducts it or whether it reports in public. Two consultations opened and neither carries a draft text: [a strategic consultation on the national digital transformation agenda on 6 August](#) and [a regulatory one on satellite communications closing 31 August](#). China [made about EUR 9.3m available for a third phase of the urban surveillance programme](#), covering command centres, data centres and base stations in three towns, with no retention rule or oversight arrangement published for it or for the two phases before it. A municipal council [presented a 17-service platform for operation by the end of 2026](#).

Governance

Strategies, plans and policies

A [strategic consultation on the national digital transformation agenda was convened in Praia on 6 August](#), seating public administration, private sector, academia and named specialists, whose contributions are to feed a national diagnosis and the agenda's priorities. Its stated scope runs from interoperability of the public administration to digital inclusion, data protection and cybersecurity. No draft, title, adoption date or budget is held, and nothing connects it to the governance framework whose terms of reference the finance ministry issued in 2025.

Legislation and regulation

The regulator [opened a public consultation on licensing, spectrum use, frequency coordination, user protection, network security and emergency communications for satellite operators, with submissions to 31 August](#). It is a direct response to the satellite service launched in the archipelago in December 2024, and is distinct from the general-authorisation regime under which that service was licensed. No draft text or adoption date is published.

Standards

The Prime Minister told Parliament during the State of the Nation debate on 31 July 2026 that the statistics institute had produced falsified data, and announced an independent evaluation to establish alleged interference and manipulation. On 3 August the institute's board rejected the allegations clearly, firmly and categorically, and said it was available to receive any external evaluation mission or peer review, undertaking to supply all technical

documentation ([both accounts](#)). Nothing is established about the evaluation's terms of reference, who conducts it, when it reports, or whether its findings will be published. The dispute is not new — anonymous technicians raised it in August 2025 and the institute rejected it in September 2025 — and the two accounts remain unreconciled.

ICT Infrastructure

Connectivity

The regulator's quarterly market series, which had stopped at the second quarter of 2025 in this base, resumed on 5 August with the [first-quarter 2026 report](#): 588,603 active SIM cards at 113.9% penetration, down 0.8% on the quarter, and 511,702 internet access subscriptions, up 1% on the quarter and down 4% on the year. The composition of internet access moved rather than its level — mobile broadband subscriptions fell 16.4% year on year while fixed broadband rose 12.9%, and 86% of subscriptions are still delivered over mobile broadband on a small screen. Market shares by internet subscription are CVTelecom 72%, Unitel T+ 27.3% and Starlink 0.64%, the satellite operator up 0.20 percentage points on the quarter. The series carries no breakdown by island or municipality.

Cybersecurity

The surveillance programme moved to a third phase on foreign money. China [made about EUR 9.3m available as non-reimbursable assistance for phase three of the Cidade Segura project](#), the implementation agreement signed in the week to 15 August by the interior minister and the Chinese ambassador at the National Police Command Centre in Praia, and stated as reinforcing the technological and operational capacity of the security forces and supporting criminal investigation. [Phase three covers command centres, data centres and wireless base stations at Assomada, Tarrafal de Santiago and Porto Novo, and expanded video surveillance in Praia and Mindelo](#). No camera count, retention rule, data-protection authorisation or oversight arrangement is published for this phase or the two before it.

DPI

Other GovTech and e-Gov

A municipal council [presented a services platform it plans to put into public presentation in October 2026 and into operation by the end of that year, opening with 17 services - applications submitted, cases tracked in real time, payments made and official documents received in digital form with legal validity](#). It is funded by the UN joint office, whose resident coordinator asked the council to consider integrating further procedures in a second phase, while the minister for family, inclusion, social development and labour argued for keeping and improving traditional counter services for those still facing difficulties with digital access, and for replicating the model in the other municipalities if it succeeds.

Technology

Innovation ecosystem

The innovation record moved to the extent that two institutions said they intend to work together. The national university and the economy ministry [are projecting a partnership on innovation, entrepreneurship and employment](#). Projected is the operative word: no scope, funding or programme accompanies it, and nothing here is yet an instrument the base can track.

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